

THE STONE AGE: PALAEOLITHIC & MESOLITHIC

STONE AGE CHRONOLOGICAL-CLIMATIC SPINE → STONE IS A BEHAVIOURAL → LITHIC SYSTEMS COMPARED → INDIAN SITE MAP: REGION → MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP → ROCK ART AND SYMBOLIC

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g14 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 STONE AGE CHRONOLOGICAL-CLIMATIC SPINE

STONE AGE CHRONOLOGICAL-CLIMATIC SPINE PLEISTOCENE HOLOCENE LOWER PALAEOLITHIC MIDDLE PALAEOLITHIC UPPER PALAEOLITHIC MESOLITHIC HANDAXE/CLEAVER FLAKES/PREPARED CORES BLADES/BONE/ART MICROLITHS MOBILE LANDSCAPES FLEXIBLE

TRANSITIONS ARE REGIONALLY STAGGERED; TOOL CHANGE IS NOT A

PLEISTOCENE HOLOCENE

Lower Palaeolithic → Middle Palaeolithic → Upper Palaeolithic → Mesolithic handaxe/cleaver flakes/prepared

cores blades/bone/art microliths mobile landscapes flexible reduction wider symbolism diverse niches

Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- PLEISTOCENE HOLOCENE
- Lower Palaeolithic → Middle Palaeolithic → Upper Palaeolithic → Mesolithic handaxe/cleaver flakes/prepared

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- cores blades/bone/art microliths mobile landscapes flexible reduction wider symbolism diverse niches
- Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.

IMPACT / LIMIT

- PLEISTOCENE HOLOCENE
- Lower Palaeolithic → Middle Palaeolithic → Upper Palaeolithic → Mesolithic handaxe/cleaver flakes/prepared

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Transitions are regionally staggered; tool change is not a single species timetable.

01

STAGE 01 STONE IS A BEHAVIOURAL ARCHIVE

STONE IS A BEHAVIOURAL ARCHIVE RAW-MATERIAL NODULE CORE REDUCTION TOOL USE DISCARD SOURCE DISTANCE SKILL/PLANNING EDGE DAMAGE ACTIVITY AREA ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE

A LABELLED TOOL WITHOUT CONTEXT CANNOT ESTABLISH AGE, SPECIES

RAW-MATERIAL NODULE → CORE REDUCTION → FLAKE/BLADE → TOOL USE → DISCARD source distance skill/planning

ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT → BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE

A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- RAW-MATERIAL NODULE → CORE REDUCTION → FLAKE/BLADE → TOOL USE → DISCARD source distance skill/planning edge damage activity area
- ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT → BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.
- RAW-MATERIAL NODULE → CORE REDUCTION → FLAKE/BLADE → TOOL USE → DISCARD source distance skill/planning edge damage activity area

DEBATE / LEGACY

- ASSEMBLAGE + STRATIGRAPHY + DATING + PALAEOENVIRONMENT → BEHAVIOURAL INFERENCE
- A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A labelled tool without context cannot establish age, species or complete lifeway.

02

STAGE 02 LITHIC SYSTEMS COMPARED

LITHIC SYSTEMS COMPARED LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC BIFACES, CLEAVERS FLAKE TOOLS BLADES TECHNOLOGY RECORDS CHOICES; OLDER TECHNIQUES MAY PERSIST BESIDE NEWER PREPARED-CORE PLANNING BONE/ORNAMENT GROWTH HAFTED COMPOSITES QUARTZITE COMMON RAW-MATERIAL

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC bifaces, cleavers flake tools blades, burins geometric microliths large cutting tools

prepared-core planning bone/ornament growth hafted composites quartzite common raw-material economy symbolic evidence bow/sickle/barb uses

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.

DEBATE / LEGACY

prepared-core planning bone/ornament growth hafted composites quartzite common raw-material economy symbolic evidence bow/sickle/barb uses

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC bifaces, cleavers flake tools blades, burins geometric microliths large cutting tools
- prepared-core planning bone/ornament growth hafted composites quartzite common raw-material economy symbolic evidence bow/sickle/barb uses

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.
- LOWER MIDDLE UPPER MESOLITHIC bifaces, cleavers flake tools blades, burins geometric microliths large cutting tools

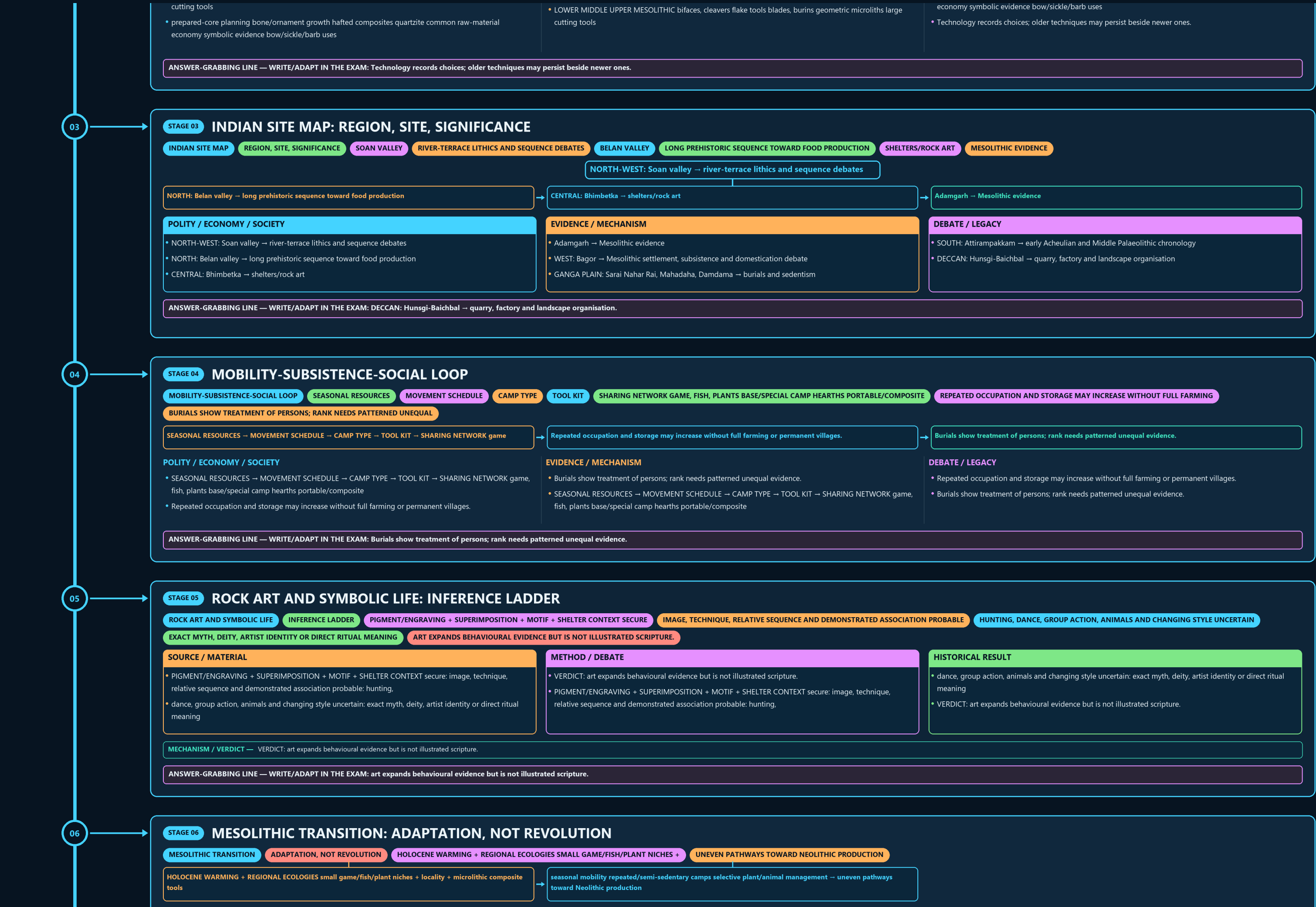
DEBATE / LEGACY

- prepared-core planning bone/ornament growth hafted composites quartzite common raw-material economy symbolic evidence bow/sickle/barb uses
- Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Technology records choices; older techniques may persist beside newer ones.

03

STAGE 03 INDIAN SITE MAP: REGION, SITE, SIGNIFICANCE



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

06

STAGE 06 MESOLITHIC TRANSITION: ADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTION

MESOLITHIC TRANSITION

ADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTION

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches +

UNEVEN PATHWAYS TOWARD NEOLITHIC PRODUCTION

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools

seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools
- seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools
- seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

DEBATE / LEGACY

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools
- seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production.

07

STAGE 07 LIMITS AND CURRENT RESEARCH

LIMITS AND CURRENT RESEARCH

SPARSE FOSSILS + DISTURBED SITES + BROAD TOOL LABELS

FALSE SHORTCUTS

ONE TOOL

ONE PEOPLE

DATE CONTEXTS, RECONSTRUCT REDUCTION SEQUENCE, COMPARE REGIONS, STATE CONFIDENCE

REFINED CHRONOMETRY AND LANDSCAPE STUDY CAN REVISE EARLY DATES.

INDIAN PREHISTORY IS A MOSAIC OF LONG CONTINUITY AND

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PROBLEM: sparse fossils + disturbed sites + broad tool labels + uncertain associations
- FALSE SHORTCUTS: one tool = one people
- innovation = migration

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- burial = hierarchy
- RESPONSE: date contexts, reconstruct reduction sequence, compare regions, state confidence
- Refined chronometry and landscape study can revise early dates.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

08

STAGE 08 STONE AGE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

STONE AGE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10 MARKS

DEFINE PHASE

DIAGNOSTIC TECHNOLOGY

TWO SITES

15 MARKS

LITHIC COMPARISON

SYMBOLIC EVIDENCE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: define phase → diagnostic technology → two sites → subsistence → caution
- 15 MARKS: chronology → lithic comparison → ecology/mobility → symbolic evidence → limits

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: geological frame → methods → four-stage technology → regional site map
- economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict

DEBATE / LEGACY

- MUST DISTINGUISH: relative/absolute date; artefact/assemblage; microlith/sedentism.
- CLOSE: technology records adaptive choices, not a uniform evolutionary ladder.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict.

09

STAGE 09 EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

EVIDENCE LADDER

FROM SOURCE BOOK

STANDARD KNOWLEDGE

CURRENT AFFAIRS.

2. ADAMGARH (MP) AND BAGOR (RAJASTHAN) PROVIDE EARLY EVIDENCE

3. BHIMBETKA IS A KEY ROCK-ART AND PREHISTORIC OCCUPATION

SOURCE TYPE CONTROLS THE STRENGTH AND LIMITS OF THE

SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
EVIDENCE LADDER	2. Adamgarh (MP) and Bagor (Rajasthan) provide early evidence for...	VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.	3. Bhimbetka is a key rock-art and prehistoric occupation site.	EVIDENCE LADDER
SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
• EVIDENCE LADDER	• 2. Adamgarh (MP) and Bagor (Rajasthan) provide early evidence for...	• VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
• 1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.	• 3. Bhimbetka is a key rock-art and prehistoric occupation site.	• EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.

SOURCE / MATERIAL

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.

3. Bhimbetka is a key rock-art and prehistoric occupation site.

METHOD / DEBATE

2. Adamgarh (MP) and Bagor (Rajasthan) provide early evidence for...

3. Bhimbetka is a key rock-art and prehistoric occupation site.

VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

EVIDENCE LADDER

HISTORICAL RESULT

VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

10

STAGE 10

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. B-04 DOMESTICATION AND SAMBHAR CLAIMS WITH CAUTION CARDS

2. A-06 ROCK ART AND CULT EVIDENCE WITH CAUTION

3. CONTESTED ISSUES COMPETING INTERPRETATIONS ARE ATTRIBUTED, EVIDENCED

QUALIFICATION EARNS MARKS; FALSE CERTAINTY IS A HARD FAILURE.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. B-04 Domestication and Sambhar claims with caution Cards 13, 17 and 21

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

2. A-06 Rock art and cult evidence with caution Cards 14 and 19

3. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...

DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. B-04 Domestication and Sambhar claims with caution Cards 13, 17 and 21

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

2. A-06 Rock art and cult evidence with caution Cards 14 and 19

3. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...

DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

11

STAGE 11

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

ANSWER SPINE

1. PRACTICE CONTRACT EVERY SOLVED ITEM HAS DEMAND DECODING

2. [INTERPRETATION] DATING, REGIONALITY, CONTINUITY, DEBATES AND UPSC

3. METHOD

FACTS FROM SOURCES ARE LABELLED FACT; ANALYTICAL SYNTHESIS IS

CLAIM, NAMED EVIDENCE, ANALYSIS AND QUALIFICATION LEAD TO A

ANSWER SPINE

→

1. Practice contract Every solved item has demand decoding, an examiner

→

2. [Interpretation] Dating, regionality, continuity, debates and UPSC

→

3. METHOD: Facts from sources are labelled FACT; analytical synthesis is

→

VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

ANSWER SPINE

1. Practice contract Every solved item has demand decoding, an examiner-...

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

2. [Interpretation] Dating, regionality, continuity, debates and UPSC...

3. METHOD: Facts from sources are labelled FACT; analytical synthesis is...

DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...

ANSWER SPINE

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

6. CURRENT LINK

7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

Mini-timeline

1. Snapshot & core idea

2. Key classification / data

3. Study links

ADVANCED DEBATE

4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

5. UPSC Traps

6. Current link

7. Mains angles

LEGACY / NUANCE

She discusses Lower, Middle and Upper Palaeolithic sites separately, including tool types and manufacturing contexts.

Isampur is treated as a centre of stone-tool manufacture.

Middle Palaeolithic discussions include Attirampakkam and the Levallois technique.

Mesolithic levels can yield animal bones and pottery; some claims of domesticated cattle, sheep, goat, dog and pig are questioned.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

THE STONE AGE: PALAEOLITHIC & MESOLITHIC • TILE 4/4 • same master rows 8178-11412 of 11412 • end